Australian freshwater turtles

The Murray-Darling Basin is home to a **diverse** range of freshwater turtles.

☞ **1** Add the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to the notes below.

The family Chelidae

- Twenty-four sp__c__ __s found in Australia
- Three d__ff__r__nt species in the Murray-Darling Basin alone

Broad-shelled t__rtl__

- Largest Australian freshwater turtle
- Found in slow-moving m__ddy water on river b__tt__ms
- Predator that __tt__cks fast moving prey: shrimp, sm__ll fish

Snake-necked turtle

- F__ __nd in swamps, b__ll__b__ngs and on land
- Eats __ns__ct larvae, larval **crustaceans**, d__ __d fish

Macquarie turtle

- Found in l__rg__ rivers, w__t__rh__l__s
- Eats __lg__ __, **aquatic** plants and insects, dead fish
- Basks on exposed l__gs or rocks

2 Decide whether each of these statements is true or false.

a) Freshwater turtles all eat the same things. _____

b) The Snake-necked turtle is a **carnivore**. _____

c) The Broad-shelled turtle is Australia's biggest freshwater turtle. _____

d) The Murray-Darling Basin has many different freshwater **ecosystems**. _____

e) The Macquarie turtle hides on murky river bottoms. _____

© Beth Montgomery and Blake Education 2012
ISBN 978 1 92571 041 0